

Tesla in HPC servers

IBM installs NVIDIA's Tesla T20-series computing processors inside their new System X iDataPlex dx360 M3 high performance servers

No more BFG graphics

BFG, an NVIDIA-only vendor, has quit the graphics card business, evidently to concentrate more on building gaming systems

the darker green of the leaves themselves. However, this is at slightly lower brightness settings. If one raises the brightness a bit, the detail in darker scenes will be lost. Input lag is noticeable, but it's not as bad as the LED displays we tested last year. Brightness levels definitely need to be slightly higher, but not at the expense of blacks. Samsung's Internet@TV is supported – a LAN port is provided for this, allowing access to certain sites like Yahoo and Flickr. The widget-based interface is decent to use, and you can add and delete widgets accordingly.

As with anything new and shiny, prices are always a little insane. The UA40C6900 retails for Rs. 1,05,000 – a fair bit of cash that can buy you a very decent 50-inch plasma display, with a better blackness level. That being said, LED-backlighting is quite the rage now, and most consumers who crave sex appeal from their TV sets have certainly come to the right place. If you've got deep pockets, and looks are more important to you than ultimate visual quality, the UA40C6900 is right up your alley.

Sony Bravia 40NX500

Black lover

This display dismayed us with its ultra wide bezel that makes it look somewhat a fossil in this age of stiletto-like bezels; where looks are sometimes all that matters. The stand has a half brushed aluminium, half piano black finish and is quite large, and very plain looking. The remote control unit is pretty nice and the entire base slides out to access the batteries – build quality of everything is top class. The buttons on the display are really good – located on the side, but have great feed-



back and are intuitive. The menu system is simple, but requires more button presses than LG's menu, to get things done. The "Favourite" menu is a nice addition where you can add commonly changed settings for quick access. Sony's remote has a peculiarity where it's easy to press the channel change keys when using the directional keys, because both these keys are designed as concentric rings – this is particularly annoying when one tries to move around the menus as we had to keep looking at the remote to avoid hitting the wrong key.

Testing confirmed highly deficient reds; we could not get the reds to the point we wanted, even though we tried to increase the red bias and reduce the blue bias. We ended up with a warm, orange hue to the picture. Keeping colours neutral, red is deficient. Once decently calibrated, we saw a very good blackness level and the Spyder agreed with us by throwing up a minimum luminance of 0.14 – this is excellent, although the colours were not absolutely neutral, and the picture had a slightly but noticeable reddish hue. The screen is very reflective – not good unless you're prepared

to keep all the lights off while viewing it. It does an excellent job of native 1080p movies – great blackness level, great colours, (with the slight reddish tinge), and superb contrast, but it doesn't do as well with non-native content, including 720p content – the upscaling was noticeable. DVD videos

Sharp Aquos LC40L50M



also gave us a similar problem.

Our DivX movie did not play as advertised when we used the USB ports, although images worked fine. We tried another DivX file to the same effect – the other displays that supported DivX through USB didn't give this problem. Priced at Rs. 68,900, the 40NX500 is a good TV, but it could do with a slight price reduction – there

are bigger displays available for close to the same price. However, that doesn't change the fact that the 40NX500 has a very sweet contrast ratio and good overall quality – this was our overall Best Performer. It's brilliant contrast, great performance in the gaming arena and native 1080p content ensured it earned this spot.

Sharp Aquos LC40L50M

Hey there sharp lookin!

This display exudes build quality. It's well designed, the rear body has great quality plastics – the remote control is also very well built. The bezel is a little wide, but no wider than LG's displays that look smaller owing to the outer bezel being made of transparent fibre. The menus are decent, but laid out with a weird colour scheme